SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

12 August 2021 · Shift 1

66 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 34 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

English Language 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. Did you do "what I telling you" to do yesterday?

(A) what I told you
(B) that I am telling you
(C) No improvement
(D) what I have told you

Q.2

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank in the given sentence. Unable to check her _____, Alice ran after the rabbit down the rabbit hole.

(A) nervousness
(B) pleasure
(C) wisdom
(D) curiosity

Q.3

Fill in the blank with most appropriate word. Thunder and lightning was _____ with heavy rain.

(A) accrued
(B) accorded
(C) accompanied
(D) accustomed

Q.4

Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word. MORBID

(A) horrid
(B) cheerful
(C) gloomy
(D) cruel

Q.5

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. Mary Kom has won numerous boxing championships.

(A) Numerous boxing championships are being won by Mary Kom.
(B) Numerous boxing championships have been won by Mary Kom.
(C) Numerous boxing championships were won by Mary Kom.
(D) Numerous boxing championships had been won by Mary Kom.

Q.6

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. My brother said to me, "Have you read the newspaper today?"

(A) My brother asked me if you have read the newspaper today.
(B) My brother asked me if I had read the newspaper today.
(C) My brother asked me if I had read the newspaper that day.
(D) My brother asked me have you read the newspaper today.

Q.7

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. AVOID

(A) Meet
(B) Avert
(C) Bypass
(D) Dodge

Q.9

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. ANTICIPATE

(A) Prefer
(B) Accept
(C) Expect
(D) Doubt

Q.10

Select the misspelt word.

(A) strugle
(B) propel
(C) fulfil
(D) several

Q.11

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. The town of Lustenau in Austria claims to have built a world record-breaking bonfire. B. The structure took three months to build but collapsed in less than half an hour last Saturday evening. C. Embers from the big fire fell onto nearby market traders, but local fire crews were on hand to make sure that everyone was safe. D. According to the organizers, the pyre reached as high as 60 meters.

(A) ABCD
(B) ADBC
(C) ACBD
(D) ABDC

Q.12

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. Please refrain to going out without a face mask.

(A) without a
(B) going out
(C) Please refrain to
(D) face mask

Q.13

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. An institution for the care of people who are mentally ill

(A) Asylum
(B) Sanatorium
(C) Dormitory
(D) Infirmary

Q.14

Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words. one who investigates and solves crimes

(A) lawyer
(B) criminal
(C) detective
(D) journalist

Q.15

In the given sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. Vincent Jonson, a musician, are going to lead an 80-man naval band in the Republic Day Parade this year.

(A) are going to lead
(B) an 80-man naval band
(C) Vincent Jonson, a musician
(D) in the Republic Day Parade this year

Q.16

Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Select the option that gives their correct order. A. He seemed to remain that high for nearly two years. B. Kari, the elephant was five months old when he was given to me to take care of. C. We grew together, that is probably why I never found out just how tall he was. D. I was nine years old and I could reach his back if I stood on tiptoe.

(A) BDAC
(B) BCAD
(C) ADCB
(D) DBCA

Q.17

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Location
(B) Education
(C) Meditation
(D) Avertion

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Full of beans

(A) Happy and energetic
(B) Sad and dull
(C) Being foolish
(D) Have crazy ideas

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. JEOPARDY

(A) peril
(B) destiny
(C) safety
(D) fortune

Q.20

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. Their marriage wasn't working but they "kept up appearances".

(A) maintained an expression of well being
(B) maintained peace and harmony
(C) kept throwing parties
(D) revealed the truth

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Seventy-year-old Bapak Gilang sat in his favourite rocking chair in his (1) _____ villa. He was staring at the evening sky (2) _____ the open window. It was already (3) _____ and it was very windy. He (4) _____ the dark clouds and felt a little (5) _____ today. He reflected that like the dusk sky, his days were also wrapped in clouds of loneliness.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 1.

(A) specific
(B) spreading
(C) spiral
(D) spacious

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Seventy-year-old Bapak Gilang sat in his favourite rocking chair in his (1) _____ villa. He was staring at the evening sky (2) _____ the open window. It was already (3) _____ and it was very windy. He (4) _____ the dark clouds and felt a little (5) _____ today. He reflected that like the dusk sky, his days were also wrapped in clouds of loneliness.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 2.

(A) with
(B) among
(C) between
(D) through

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Seventy-year-old Bapak Gilang sat in his favourite rocking chair in his (1) _____ villa. He was staring at the evening sky (2) _____ the open window. It was already (3) _____ and it was very windy. He (4) _____ the dark clouds and felt a little (5) _____ today. He reflected that like the dusk sky, his days were also wrapped in clouds of loneliness.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3.

(A) dusk
(B) noon
(C) morning
(D) dawn

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Seventy-year-old Bapak Gilang sat in his favourite rocking chair in his (1) _____ villa. He was staring at the evening sky (2) _____ the open window. It was already (3) _____ and it was very windy. He (4) _____ the dark clouds and felt a little (5) _____ today. He reflected that like the dusk sky, his days were also wrapped in clouds of loneliness.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 4.

(A) glanced
(B) peered
(C) stared
(D) observed

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number. Seventy-year-old Bapak Gilang sat in his favourite rocking chair in his (1) _____ villa. He was staring at the evening sky (2) _____ the open window. It was already (3) _____ and it was very windy. He (4) _____ the dark clouds and felt a little (5) _____ today. He reflected that like the dusk sky, his days were also wrapped in clouds of loneliness.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 5.

(A) pensive
(B) innocent
(C) attentive
(D) delighted

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Q.2

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term. Healthy Diet : Tiredness :: Carefulness : ?

(A) Activeness
(B) Satisfied
(C) Accident
(D) Successful

Q.3

Select the correct option that indicates the arrangement of the given words in the order in which they appear in an English dictionary. 1. Indiscipline 2. Indetermination 3. Indelicate 4. Indictable 5. Independent

(A) 3, 5, 2, 4, 1
(B) 2, 3, 5, 1, 4
(C) 2, 3, 5, 4, 1
(D) 3, 2, 5, 1, 4

Q.4

In a code language, LANCER is written as NALREC. How will NORWAY be written in that language?

(A) RONYAW
(B) YAWRON
(C) YAWNOR
(D) RNOYAW

Q.5

Select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 46, 47, 94, 97, 388, ?

(A) 398
(B) 393
(C) 419
(D) 411

Q.7

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given series will complete the series. _ k l _ l j _ j k j _ l _ l j

(A) j l k l k
(B) k j l l k
(C) l k l j k
(D) j k l k k

Q.8

Select the option in which the words share the same relationship as that shared by the given pair of words.
Sheep : Lamb

(A) Leopard : Larva
(B) Cow : Calf
(C) Crow : Cub
(D) Panda : Infant

Q.10

Which two numbers should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 64 + 36 ÷ 3 × 9 – 32 = 44

(A) 3 and 9
(B) 32 and 36
(C) 64 and 36
(D) 9 and 64

Q.11

Four letter-clusters have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the letter-cluster that is different.

(A) WBYT
(B) YDWR
(C) MRGB
(D) CHSN

Q.12

In a certain code language, GATHER is coded as 107 and HONOUR is coded as 74. How will HEAVEN be coded in that language?

(A) 131
(B) 101
(C) 110
(D) 113

Q.13

Select the option that is related to the third number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number. 364 : 183 : : 462 : ?

(A) 297
(B) 279
(C) 232
(D) 223

Q.14

Four numbers have been given, out of which three are alike in some manner and one is different. Select the number that is different.

(A) 1587
(B) 3462
(C) 1273
(D) 5789

Q.15

Three of the following four words are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the odd one.

(A) Newspaper
(B) Magazine
(C) Publisher
(D) Book

Q.16

Ranjan in his ODI Cricket career, scored 15 runs on an average in 10 matches. If he scored 14 runs on an average in the first 4 matches and 12 runs on an average in the last 4 matches, then find the average of the runs scored by him in the remaining 2 matches.

(A) 24
(B) 23
(C) 25
(D) 22

Q.21

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. PLMO : PNMQ : : UDMS : ?

(A) RNEJ
(B) TQFV
(C) TNCA
(D) TNEV

Q.22

Select the option in which the numbers share the same relationship as that shared by the numbers of the given set. (277, 14, 9)

(A) (364, 11, 12)
(B) (123, 17, 8)
(C) (313, 12, 13)
(D) (198, 15, 8)

Q.23

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. 12 15 11; 14 5 17; 16 ? 19

(A) 9
(B) 7
(C) 5
(D) 3

Q.25

Two statements are given, followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All roads are cycles. No cycle is a car. Conclusions: I. Some cycles are roads. II. No road is a car. III. No car is a cycle.

(A) All the conclusions follow
(B) Only conclusions I and III follow
(C) Only conclusions II and III follow
(D) Only conclusions I and II follow

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Coringa is a beautiful _____ forest where the Godavari joins the backwaters of Bay of Bengal.

(A) evergreen
(B) coniferous
(C) mangrove
(D) deciduous

Q.2

Arthunkal Feast and Vettukad Festival are church festivals from the state of _____.

(A) Nagaland
(B) Goa
(C) Sikkim
(D) Kerala

Q.3

Who among the following has received the Female Sportsperson of the Year Award at the FICCI India Sports Award in December 2020?

(A) Saina Nehwal
(B) Manu Bhakhar
(C) Deepika Kumari
(D) Elavenil Valarivan

Q.4
Which Indian state is divided into Majha, Doaba and Malwa regions?

(A) Assam
(B) Karnataka
(C) Punjab
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Q.5
Who is the second Indian footballer to play 100 international games?

(A) Bhaichung Bhutia
(B) Sunil Chhetri
(C) Gurpreet Singh Sandhu
(D) Udanta Singh

Q.6
Rain is liquid _____.

(A) precipitation
(B) condensation
(C) decantation
(D) sedimentation

Q.7
In which of the following years did the Indian National Congress make the demand for a Constituent Assembly?

(A) 1939
(B) 1919
(C) 1928
(D) 1934

Q.8
For the residents of which of the following union territories PM Narendra Modi has launched Ayushman Bharat - Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojna (AB - PMJAY) 'Sehat Scheme' in December 2020?

(A) Jammu and Kashmir
(B) Ladakh
(C) Chandigarh
(D) Puducherry

Q.9
The Indian Mutiny of 1857 effectively ended in the city of _____.

(A) Gwalior
(B) Amritsar
(C) Lucknow
(D) Vadodara

Q.10
In which of the following years PM-KISAN (Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi) was formally launched?

(A) 2019
(B) 2014
(C) 2015
(D) 2017

Q.11
What is the pH value of acidic substances?

(A) Below 1.0
(B) Below 4.0
(C) Below 2.0
(D) Below 7.0

Q.12
Who among the following cricketers is the brand ambassador of a fantasy sports gaming platform, Paytm First Games?

(A) Sachin Tendulkar
(B) Rohit Sharma
(C) Yuvraj Singh
(D) Virat Kohli

Q.13
Which amendment of the Constitution of India incorporated Goa, Daman and Diu as the eighth union territory of India, by amending the First Schedule to the Constitution?

(A) 13th
(B) 10th
(C) 12th
(D) 18th

Q.14
Chambal is a tributary of which of the following rivers?

(A) Narmada
(B) Yamuna
(C) Ganga
(D) Brahmaputra

Q.15
Who among the following became the first Indian-Kiwi woman to become a minister in New Zealand in 2020?

(A) Priyanca Radhakrishnan
(B) Manisha Singh
(C) Seema Verma
(D) Anita Anand

Q.16
Who among the following was the first Indian to win the Miss World beauty pageant?

(A) Reita Faria
(B) Aishwarya Rai
(C) Diana Hayden
(D) Priyanka Chopra

Q.17
Which of the following is a method of describing computer algorithms using a combination of natural language and programming language?

(A) Node
(B) Pseudocode
(C) Flowchart
(D) Array

Q.18
_____ is a process of forming a thick oxide layer of aluminium.

(A) Galvanisation
(B) Ductility
(C) Corrosion
(D) Anodising

Q.19
When is the National Consumer Rights Day observed in India every year?

(A) 13 March
(B) 2 October
(C) 24 December
(D) 24 November

Q.20
In which state will you find Mayurbhanj district, the last among the princely states, that merged with the state?

(A) Kerala
(B) Jharkhand
(C) Odisha
(D) Chhattisgarh

Q.21
_____ is an interpreted, high-level and general-purpose programming language.

(A) Python
(B) Spider
(C) Penguin
(D) Cookie

Q.22
Who among the following had authored ‘Buddha Gaya: The Hermitage of Sakya Muni’ in 1878?

(A) Alexander Cunningham
(B) Rajendralala Mitra
(C) HH Cole
(D) John Marshall

Q.23
NTPC and _____ have signed an MoU to set up a joint venture for 'renewable energy business'.

(A) Reliance Petroleum
(B) Coal India
(C) NHPC Limited
(D) ONGC

Q.24

Colonel (retd) Narendra Kumar, an Indian soldier and _____, passed away in December 2020.

(A) mountaineer
(B) singer
(C) boxer
(D) wrestler

Q.25

Kalbelia folk songs and dance forms are an expression of the Kalbelia community's traditional way of life. It is associated with which of the following states?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Haryana
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Punjab

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(A)**

General Intelligence

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**
Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**
Q.16 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.25 **(A)**	

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (A) what I told you

'Yesterday' calls for the past simple: 'Did you do what I told you to do yesterday?'

Q.2 · Answer (D) curiosity

Alice could not hold back her 'curiosity', the wish to know, so she followed the rabbit down its hole.

Q.3 · Answer (C) accompanied

To be 'accompanied' with or by something is to have it come along at the same time. 'Accrued', 'accorded' and 'accustomed' make no sense here.

Q.4 · Answer (B) cheerful

'Morbid' means having an unhealthy interest in gloomy things such as death; its opposite is 'cheerful'. 'Gloomy' and 'horrid' are close to it in meaning.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Numerous boxing championships have been won by Mary Kom.

The present perfect 'has won' becomes 'have been won', plural to agree with 'numerous boxing championships'.

Q.6 · Answer (C) My brother asked me if I had read the newspaper that day.

A question is reported with 'asked … if'; 'you' becomes 'I', the present perfect 'have read' becomes the past perfect 'had read', and 'today' becomes 'that day'.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Meet

To 'avoid' someone is to keep away from them; the opposite is to 'meet' them. 'Avert', 'bypass' and 'dodge' are close to synonyms.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Expect

To 'anticipate' something is to 'expect' it.

Q.10 · Answer (A) strugle

The correct spelling is 'struggle'. 'Fulfil' is the British spelling.

Q.11 · Answer (B) ADBC

A introduces the record-breaking bonfire, D gives its height, B tells how long it took to build and how quickly it fell, and C what happened to its embers: ADBC.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Please refrain to

'Refrain' takes 'from' and a gerund: 'Please refrain from going out without a face mask.'

Q.13 · Answer (A) Asylum

An asylum (an old term) is an institution for the care of the mentally ill. A sanatorium treats long-term illnesses such as tuberculosis, and an infirmary is a place for the sick, as in a school.

Q.14 · Answer (C) detective

A detective investigates and solves crimes.

Q.15 · Answer (A) are going to lead

The subject, 'Vincent Jonson', is singular (the phrase 'a musician' only describes him), so it takes 'is going to lead'.

Q.16 · Answer (A) BDAC

B introduces Kari at five months old, D gives the narrator's age and how he could just reach Kari's back, A says Kari stayed that high for two years and C explains why the narrator never knew how tall he was: BDAC.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Avertion

The correct spelling is 'aversion'.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Happy and energetic
To be 'full of beans' is to be lively and full of energy.

Q.19 · Answer (A) peril
'Jeopardy' means danger: 'peril'.

Q.20 · Answer (A) maintained an expression of well being
To 'keep up appearances' is to pretend that all is well, hiding one's troubles from others.

Q.21 · Answer (D) spacious
A roomy, 'spacious' villa, where he sat in his favourite chair.

Q.22 · Answer (D) through
He looked at the sky 'through' the open window.

Q.23 · Answer (A) dusk
It was evening, as the passage says, and it later speaks of 'the dusk sky': it was already 'dusk'.

Q.24 · Answer (D) observed
Only 'observed' takes a direct object: 'He observed the dark clouds'. 'Glanced', 'peered' and 'stared' would need 'at'.

Q.25 · Answer (A) pensive
Thinking about his lonely days, he felt a little 'pensive', thoughtful and sad.

General Intelligence

Q.2 · Answer (C) Accident
A healthy diet keeps tiredness away, as carefulness keeps accidents away.

Q.3 · Answer (A) 3, 5, 2, 4, 1
In dictionary order: Indelicate (3), Independent (5), Indetermination (2), Indictable (4), Indiscipline (1). 'Inde' comes before 'Indi', 'Indel' before 'Indep' before 'Indet', and 'Indic' before 'Indis'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) RONYAW
Each half of the word is reversed: LAN → NAL and CER → REC. So NOR → RON and WAY → YAW: RONYAW.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 393
The steps alternate between adding and multiplying by 1, 2, 3, 4, 5: 46 + 1 = 47, 47 × 2 = 94, 94 + 3 = 97, 97 × 4 = 388, so 388 + 5 = 393.

Q.7 · Answer (D) j k l k k
With j, k, l, k, k in the blanks the series reads jkl klj ljk jkl klj: each block of three moves its first letter to the end.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Cow : Calf
A lamb is the young of a sheep, as a calf is the young of a cow.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 3 and 9
Interchanging 3 and 9: 64 + 36 ÷ 9 × 3 − 32 = 64 + 12 − 32 = 44.

Q.11 · Answer (C) MRGB
In WBYT, YDWR and CHSN the second letter is 5 places after the first, the third is the second's opposite in the alphabet (B–Y, D–W, H–S) and the fourth is 5 places before the third. In MRGB the opposite of R is I, not G.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 110
Count each letter's place from Z (A = 26, …, Z = 1) and add 1 for each consonant: GATHER gives 103 + 4 = 107 and HONOUR 71 + 3 = 74. HEAVEN gives 107 + 3 (H, V, N) = 110.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 232
364 ÷ 2 + 1 = 183. Likewise 462 ÷ 2 + 1 = 232.

Q.14 · Answer (B) 3462
1587, 1273 and 5789 are odd numbers, each with three odd digits and one even. 3462 is even, with three even digits.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Publisher
Newspapers, magazines and books are publications; a publisher is the one who produces them.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 23
The 10 matches give 15 × 10 = 150 runs; the first 4 give 14 × 4 = 56 and the last 4 give 12 × 4 = 48. The other 2 give 150 − 104 = 46: an average of 23.

Q.21 · Answer (D) TNEV
Each letter moves one place forward and the cluster is then written backwards: PLMO → QMNP → PNMQ. Likewise UDMS → VENT → TNEV.

Q.22 · Answer (C) (313, 12, 13)
The first number is the sum of the squares of the other two: $14^2 + 9^2 = 196 + 81 = 277$. Likewise $12^2 + 13^2 = 144 + 169 = 313$.

Q.23 · Answer (B) 7
In each row the middle number is four times the first minus three times the third: 4 × 12 − 3 × 11 = 15 and 4 × 14 − 3 × 17 = 5. So 4 × 16 − 3 × 19 = 64 − 57 = 7.

Q.25 · Answer (A) All the conclusions follow
All roads are cycles, so some cycles are roads (I). No cycle is a car, so no car is a cycle (III), and as every road is a cycle, no road is a car (II). All three follow.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) mangrove
Coringa, in the Godavari delta in Andhra Pradesh, is a mangrove forest, protected as the Coringa Wildlife Sanctuary.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Kerala
Arthunkal, near Alappuzha, and Vettukad, in Thiruvananthapuram, are both in Kerala, and their church feasts draw large crowds.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Elavenil Valarivan
Shooter Elavenil Valarivan was named Female Sportsperson of the Year at the FICCI India Sports Awards in December 2020; wrestler Bajrang Punia won the men's award.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Punjab
Punjab's three historical regions are Majha (between the Ravi and the Beas), Doaba (between the Beas and the Sutlej) and Malwa (south of the Sutlej).

Q.5 · Answer (B) Sunil Chhetri
Sunil Chhetri played his 100th international match in June 2018; Bhaichung Bhutia had been the first Indian to reach the mark.

Q.6 · Answer (A) precipitation
Precipitation is water falling from the clouds: rain is its liquid form, and snow, sleet and hail are frozen forms.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 1934
In June 1934 the Congress Working Committee, rejecting the British White Paper on reforms, called for a constitution drawn up by a Constituent Assembly elected on adult suffrage. Some books date the first official demand to 1935, which is not an option.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Jammu and Kashmir
On 26 December 2020 the Prime Minister launched the AB-PMJAY SEHAT scheme, extending health insurance cover of ₹5 lakh a family to all residents of Jammu and Kashmir.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Gwalior
The British retook Gwalior in June 1858, after the Rani of Jhansi was killed in the fighting near the city; that effectively ended the rebellion, though scattered fighting went on into 1859.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 2019
PM-KISAN, which pays farmers ₹6,000 a year in three instalments, was launched by the Prime Minister at Gorakhpur on 24 February 2019.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Below 7.0
On the pH scale 7 is neutral; acids have a pH below 7 and bases above it.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Sachin Tendulkar
Paytm First Games named Sachin Tendulkar its brand ambassador in September 2020.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 12th
The 12th Amendment (1962) added Goa, Daman and Diu, freed from Portuguese rule in 1961, to the First Schedule as a union territory.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Yamuna
The Chambal flows north through Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan and joins the Yamuna in Uttar Pradesh.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Priyanca Radhakrishnan
Priyanca Radhakrishnan, a Labour MP born in India, became New Zealand's first minister of Indian origin when Jacinda Ardern named her new ministers in November 2020.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Reita Faria
Reita Faria won Miss World in 1966, the first Indian, and the first Asian, to do so. Aishwarya Rai won in 1994, Diana Hayden in 1997 and Priyanka Chopra in 2000.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Pseudocode
Pseudocode sets out an algorithm's steps in plain language mixed with programming constructs; a flowchart shows them as a diagram.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Anodising
Anodising thickens aluminium's natural oxide layer by electrolysis, with the aluminium as the anode, so that it resists corrosion.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 24 December
National Consumer Rights Day, 24 December, marks the day the Consumer Protection Act, 1986 received the President's assent. World Consumer Rights Day is 15 March.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Odisha
Mayurbhanj, the last of the princely states to merge with Odisha, joined it on 1 January 1949.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Python
Python, created by Guido van Rossum and first released in 1991, is an interpreted, high-level, general-purpose language.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Rajendralala Mitra
Rajendralala Mitra, the Bengali scholar and antiquarian, wrote 'Buddha Gaya: The Hermitage of Sakya Muni' (1878), a study of the temple and antiquities of Bodh Gaya.

Q.23 · Answer (D) ONGC
In May 2020 NTPC and ONGC signed an MoU to set up a joint venture for renewable energy, including offshore wind.

Q.24 · Answer (A) mountaineer
Colonel (retd) Narendra 'Bull' Kumar, a mountaineer whose reconnaissance of the Siachen Glacier preceded Operation Meghdoot (1984), died on 31 December 2020.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Rajasthan

The Kalbelia songs and dances of Rajasthan's Kalbelia community, once snake-charmers, are on UNESCO's list of intangible cultural heritage.

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